Life & Career Milestones of **DR. RAMDAS M. PAI**

Early Life & Education

Born: 17 September 1935 in Udupi, Madras Presidency, British India.

Family Background: Son of Dr. TMA Pai (founder of Manipal institutions), Padma Shri awardee and Sharada Pai

MBBS: Graduated from Kasturba Medical College, Manipal/ Karnatak University in 1958

Postgraduate: Master's in Health Administration from Temple University, Philadelphia, USA.

PROFESSIONAL JOURNEY

1961: Returned to India to begin his career as a Medical Director, taking care of Kasturba Medical College and Hospital, Manipal & Mangalore

1979: After the passing of his father, he took over leadership of the Manipal Group.

Leadership Roles:
- Chancellor, Manipal Academy of Higher Education
- Chairman, Manipal Education and Medical Group
- Executive Pro-Chancellor, Sikkim Manipal University
- President of T.A. Pai Trust
- Registrar of the Academy of General Education (All reflecting his broad stewardship of the Manipal ecosystem.)
- Chairman, JVMC Corporation Sdn.Bhd, Malaysia
- Chairman, Board of Management, Manipal University, Jaipur
- Member, Medical Council of India

1993: His leadership was instrumental in MAHE being granted "Deemed University" status by the University Grants Commission (UGC), a key milestone in the institution's development.

2001: Establishes the Manipal Foundation to formalise and run the group's philanthropic initiatives.

2020: The Government of India accords the status of Institution of Eminence Deemed to be University to MAHE.



educational ecosystem. Dubai, Malaysia, and higher education campuses in Nepal and Antigua —locations that felt distant from the red earth of Manipal—slowly became extensions of its educational ideal.

Each campus was more than an expansion. It was an assertion: Indian education, when built with integrity and imagination, could travel.

The Boy Who Watched a Town Turn Into a University

To understand the magnitude of what he achieved, one must travel back to the 1950s, when the plateau of Manipal was little more than red earth, scrubland, and stubborn hope. His father, Dr. T.M.A. Pai, a doctor by training and a nation-builder by instinct, believed education was the greatest equaliser in a newly independent India. He built, he toiled, he experimented. And in 1953, he created India's first self-financing medical college in Public-Private Partnership model (now being advocated by the regulators and Govt.), an institution that quietly challenged the belief that only government could build world-class education.

Young Ramdas witnessed this improbable metamorphosis from the front row. The boy grew into a man who inherited not merely an institution, but a philosophy: "Fix illiteracy and ill health, and poverty dissolves."

Where most saw hospitals and classrooms, he saw instruments of nation building. In this process, He expanded his father's PPP concept to the next level by establishing a medical college in Jamshedpur through Private-Private Partnership model.

But inheritance alone never builds an empire. Plenty inherit. Few transform.

The Turning Point Nobody Expected

In the early 1990s, higher education in India stood at an unusual crossroads. Globalisation was still a whisper; private universities were viewed with suspicion; leaving the sector poised between tradition and the first signs of rapid transformation. Every institution saw this as a blow.